

» INDIAN PLAYGROUND

National ranking TT: Double for Syndrela Das



Syndrela Das marked her 17th birthday in style, completing a double crown, while Payas Jain bounced back from the disappointment of losing the Commonwealth Championship final recently to headline the final day of the UTT National Ranking Table Tennis tournament in Kanpur.

On an action-packed day, the senior paddlers negotiated their final three rounds as the youth events reached their climax. Syndrela, who played seven matches without dropping a game, outclassed fellow teenager Divyanshi Bhowmick in the women's final.

Divyanshi, fresh from winning the Under-17 title and having bowed out to Ananya Muralidharan in the U-19 semifinal, tried hard to disrupt Syndrela's rhythm. But the Kolkata paddler's trademark backhand winners proved decisive. Earlier, Syndrela had accounted for Ananya in the youth girls' final.

The men's final produced more engrossing rallies. Payas' assured service reception helped him breach Manav Thakkar's defensive fort as he battled his way to a five-game victory. In the youth boys' final, Priyanuj Bhattacharyya edged Abhinandh P.B. in a 65-minute thriller. After conceding the fifth-game tie-break 21-23, Priyanuj responded with an aggressive approach, pocketing the next two games to seal the title.

The results (all finals): Men: Payas Jain (Del) bt Manav Thakkar (PSPB) 11-3, 9-11, 11-5, 12-10, 11-8.

Women: Syndrela Das (WB) bt Divyanshi Bhowmick (Mah) 9-11, 11-8, 11-8, 5-11, 11-7, 11-9.

Youth boys: Priyanuj Bhattacharyya (RSPB) bt Abhinandh P.B. (TN) 9-11, 11-5, 11-3, 8-11, 21-23, 11-4, 11-7.

Youth girls: Syndrela Das (WB) bt Ananya Muralidharan (TN) 11-8, 10-12, 11-9, 11-9, 11-4.

AMOL KARHADKAR



Winners all: Syndrela Das (middle), Payas Jain (right) and Priyanuj Bhattacharyya with their trophies. AMOL KARHADKAR

SPORTOON

